



Mr. Shrivats Singhanian (CEO)

UDAIPUR CEMENT

1. Can you please give an overview of your professional background leading up to and including your current role?

I have cultivated a diverse and dynamic professional journey that has equipped me with a robust skill set and a keen understanding of multifaceted business environments. My educational foundation was laid with a B.Sc. (Hons. in Business and Management) from IILM, New Delhi, in association with Bradford University, UK., complemented by an Associate of Arts degree from Landmark College, Putney, VT, USA. I've honed my entrepreneurial skills through management development programs, including the "Emerging Leaders Programme" from London Business School and "Effective Communication for Managerial Success" from IIM - Lucknow.

For over a decade, I've been an integral part of the JK Group, a prominent industrial conglomerate involved in various businesses, including Paper and Boards, Cement, Tyres & Tubes, V-belts, and more. My roles have included marketing for the paper business, overseeing cement manufacturing, and venturing into innovative areas like 3D Printing Services and a successful restaurant. I've been a Director on the company's Board since 2018 and took on the position of Director & CEO on January 31, 2023. Concurrently, I serve as a Director on the Board of Param Shubham Vanijya Ltd. My journey reflects a commitment to growth, innovation, and strategic leadership. I'm dedicated to steering our organisation toward sustained success and excited to leverage my extensive experience to achieve this vision.

2. What have been some of the significant highlights of Udaipur Cement Works' history?

UCWL, a trailblazer in the cement industry, has redefined industry benchmarks by drawing upon its rich heritage. We take great pride in our role as pioneers of excellence, where tradition harmonizes with innovation to shape a future built on resilience and prosperity.

Our dedication to excellence is underscored by our attainment of ISO certifications across critical domains, including Environmental Management (ISO 14001), Occupational Health and Safety (ISO 45001), Energy Management (ISO 50001), and Quality Management (ISO 9001) Systems. Beyond industry standards, we diligently gauge our carbon and water footprint, aligning with ISO 14064-1 and ISO 14046 standards. This meticulous attention to detail highlights our commitment to sustainability, ensuring that we not only meet but surpass industry benchmarks in our pursuit of environmental stewardship and corporate distinction.

In alignment with our commitment to global climate change initiatives and our obligations at COP26, UCWL is embarking on a transformative journey towards procuring sustainable energy sources. A substantial proportion, 48%, of our electricity needs are now fulfilled through eco-friendly and renewable sources, notably Solar and Waste Heat Recovery Systems (WHRS).

During the fiscal year 2021-22, we achieved a significant milestone by expanding our solar power generation capacity by 4.35 MW, increasing it from 10.1 MW to an impressive 14.45 MW. This expansion harnessed around 6000 MWh of green energy through this solar addition, which contributes in reduction of CO2 emission by 4860 MT/Annum and there is saving of 2.2 lakhs tree with this CO2 reduction.

In Jan'23 we have also commissioned floating solar of 1 MW capacity in our mines at UCWL, which is first of its kind in Rajasthan and in Indian cement industry, which will further help us to generate around 15 lakhs units/annum of electricity and there will be multiple benefits like reduction in CO2 by 1215 MT/annum and saving of around 55 thousands trees, in addition to it this floating solar will save water evaporation around 8000 M3/Year.

Sustainability has always been the bedrock of our business ethos, and we remain resolute in adopting practices that will forge a greener future for forthcoming generations. As part of this commitment, we have commissioned a groundbreaking floating solar project in our UCWL mines pit, a pioneering endeavor in Rajasthan. This unique initiative not only yields renewable electrical energy but also conserves water previously lost to evaporation.

Moreover, we have placed a strong emphasis on enhancing our water positivity index. As of FY23, we are 4.0 times water positive, with a target to achieve 5 times water positivity by FY25. Additionally, we have set an ambitious goal to attain a 20% TSR (Thermal Substitution Rate) by FY30, further bolstering our efforts to curtail greenhouse gas emissions.

● To elevate our sustainability journey, we have actively engaged in various memberships and committed to several initiatives:

SBTi (Science-Based Target initiative): We are unwavering in our commitment to limit the global temperature rise to 1.5°C above preindustrial levels and pledge to attain net-zero targets.

Re100: Our aspiration is to fulfill 100% of our total electrical energy requirements from renewable energy sources by 2040, extending

EP100: As part of the EP100 membership, we aim to double our energy productivity by 2040 compared to the baseline year 2015, also at the Group level.

● **UN Global Compact** : Our membership in the UNGC underscores our dedication to showcasing progress aligned with the Ten Principles of the UN Global Compact and the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

● **GCCA-India** : At the Group level, we have joined GCCA-India to align our sustainability objectives with those of the Indian cement industry.

At UCWL, our approach to sustainability is comprehensive, and our commitment to crafting a greener future for upcoming generations remains steadfast.

3. What are some of Udaipur Cement Works' key values and beliefs? How important is customer satisfaction?

At Udaipur Cement Works Limited (UCWL), we consistently showcase our prowess in the cement industry through a strategic and customer-centric approach to our advertising initiatives. Our multifaceted advertising strategy encompasses traditional and digital channels to amplify our brand presence. We meticulously orchestrate traditional methods such as televised broadcasts, print media, and outdoor advertising to maintain our market visibility across urban and rural areas in India. However, what truly sets us apart is our digital acumen. Recognising the increasing tech-savvy of the Indian population, we've made substantial investments in digital marketing and social media engagement.

Our active engagement on platforms like Facebook, Instagram, and LinkedIn serves as a direct means of communication with our customer base, allowing us to share product updates and industry insights. Embracing digital media and adopting a customer-centric ethos has positioned us as a formidable

player in India's cement industry. Moreover, we prioritise customer-centricity across our operations, from optimising our supply chain to enhancing customer support, aiming to deliver a seamless and personalised experience to our diverse customer base.

We also actively engage our customers through multimedia platforms, leveraging brand ambassadors and orchestrating immersive brand experiences to foster authentic connections, transcending traditional cold-selling approaches.

4. What do you think sets your business apart from its competitors?

At Udaipur Cement Works Limited (UCWL), our distinctiveness in the fiercely competitive cement industry is underscored by a combination of strategic pillars that set us apart from our rivals.

● **Quality and Innovation Leadership:**

UCWL is a paragon of quality and innovation. Our advanced manufacturing facility, equipped with cutting-edge technology, ensures unwavering product excellence. We take pride in delivering top-tier cement products that meet diverse customer needs. Our unyielding commitment to innovation fuels continuous product enhancement and the introduction of novel offerings.

● **Customer-Centric Approach:** Our customer-centric ethos is the cornerstone of our success. UCWL's extensive distribution network spans regions and market segments, bolstered by comprehensive customer support mechanisms. We provide technical assistance, feedback channels, and efficient grievance resolution systems. Through regular market surveys and customer satisfaction studies, we tailor solutions to match customer preferences precisely.

● **Social Responsibility and Sustainability:**

UCWL places a premium on social responsibility and sustainability. We actively engage with local communities, offering employment opportunities and

driving social welfare initiatives. Our conscientious efforts also extend to environmental responsibility as we strive to reduce our carbon footprint and preserve natural resources. Upholding the highest corporate governance and ethics standards underscores our commitment to responsible business practices.

● **Innovative Technical Services:**

UCWL has introduced pioneering Mobile Concrete Labs (MCLs) in our primary markets. These MCLs provide an array of technical services catering to the construction industry. From quality assessments of construction materials to on-site evaluations of fresh concrete and testing of concrete cubes, our MCLs offer convenience and precision directly at construction sites. Additionally, we provide supplementary solutions like cover blocks and shuttering tapes, mitigating cement slurry leakage risks. Our MCLs also offer expert guidance on construction methodologies and deliver tailored design mixes for concrete, ensuring comprehensive support and value-added solutions for our clients.

5. How important is culture to the business? How do you instil this in your employees?

Culture is of paramount importance to UCWL's business ethos. Our unwavering commitment to fostering an inclusive and diverse workplace forms the foundation of our corporate philosophy. We recognise that a diverse workforce, encompassing differences in gender, age, nationality, abilities, ethnic backgrounds, sexual orientation, culture, education, and professional experiences, is integral to our success.

Our dedication to creating a 'diverse and inclusive workplace' is a central imperative. This commitment extends to supporting female employees by facilitating maternity leave to enable them to fulfil their parental responsibilities. We consider inclusiveness and ethical conduct as fundamental principles

emanating from our senior leadership and permeating throughout the organisation. This approach has cultivated a harmonious, secure, and inclusive work environment where individual expression and diverse perspectives are celebrated. We take pride in our proactive measures resulting in a prior fiscal year free from incidents of racism or violence, underscoring our commitment to promoting a culture of respect and equality.

Furthermore, our Board of Directors exemplifies this commitment to diversity, bringing together a rich tapestry of academic and professional talents from various industries, including banking, insurance, corporate governance, audit services, public policy, the cement sector, emerging markets, finance, legal expertise, technology, and IT. This diversity at the highest level of our organisation reflects our dedication to inclusive leadership and decision-making.

6. What are the plans for the future in terms of expansion and growth?

UCWL currently has an installed clinker capacity of 1.5 million tons and a cement grinding capacity of 2.2 million tons, offering our customers a diverse array of ordinary Portland cement and blended cement products.

To capitalize on the flourishing demand in the infrastructure and housing sectors, which are driving good growth in the cement sector and excitingly, our plant is amid a significant expansion initiative. This expansion includes the addition of a new clinker line, contributing an additional 1.5 million tons, and the establishment of a split grinding station with a capacity of 2.5 million tons. These projects are progressing smoothly within the established schedule and are set to be commissioned by the end of the current fiscal year. Upon completion, our clinker and cement capacities will surge to 3 million tons and 4.7 million tons, respectively.

Furthermore, we are looking to the

future with ambitious plans for a third clinker line to produce another 1.5 million tons, and a matching grinding capacity of 3 million tons. With this, UCWL's capacity will increase significantly to 4.5 million tons of clinker and 7.7 million tons of cement in coming years reinforcing our position as a key player in the industry.

7. What strategies does Udaipur Cement Works have in place to improve your supply chain and build long-term relationships with key partners?

Udaipur Cement Works has strategically deployed a series of initiatives to fortify its supply chain efficacy and cultivate enduring partnerships with key stakeholders. These endeavours encompass:

- **Logistics Network Optimization:**

Udaipur Cement Works has channelled investments into enhancing its transportation and distribution infrastructure, encompassing rail sidings, road networks, warehouses, and packing facilities. This strategic move is geared towards streamlining product delivery, trimming operational costs, and expediting customer service excellence.

- **Digital Transformation:** The organisation has embarked on a digital transformation journey, embracing cutting-edge technologies such as Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP), Global Positioning System (GPS), Radio-Frequency Identification (RFID), and Internet of Things (IoT). This digital ecosystem empowers real-time inventory, orders, shipments, and product quality tracking across the entire supply chain.

- **Supplier Base Fortification :**

Udaipur Cement Works has painstakingly cultivated a robust and dependable supplier network for essential raw materials, including limestone, gypsum, fly ash, and coal. This entails forging enduring contractual relationships, ensuring punctual remittances, and enforcing stringent quality control measures.

Moreover, the organisation actively engages with local communities, proffering employment opportunities and spearheading social welfare initiatives.

- **Customer Relationship Nurturing:**

Our paramount focus lies in nurturing enduring associations with a diverse clientele comprising dealers, retailers, contractors, builders, and end-users. Udaipur Cement Works has ushered in customer-centric programs, encompassing loyalty schemes, technical support mechanisms, feedback channels, and grievance resolution frameworks. Concurrently, the organisation conducts regular market research and customer satisfaction assessments to glean invaluable insights into customer preferences and requirements, thereby enabling tailor-made solutions.

8. What are some of the key goals Mr. Shrivats Singhania and Udaipur Cement Works Company have achieved since they began their role as the Director & CEO?

In FY 2023, we achieved robust sales growth, boasting an impressive 18% increase in net sales compared to the previous fiscal year. Our sales volume also experienced steady growth, rising by 4% to reach 20.35 Lac Tonnes in FY'23 from 19.49 Lac Tonnes in FY'22.

Furthermore, our operational efficiency reached new heights during Q4FY23, with our Clinker Capacity Utilisation exceeding an exceptional 100%. In FY '23, we achieved a record-breaking Clinker Production of 14.44 Lac Tonnes, with a commendable capacity utilisation rate of 97%. In line with our commitment to sustainability, we increased the share of Renewable Energy in our total power consumption from 46% in FY'22 to an impressive 48% in FY'23. Additionally, our Renewable Energy Portfolio now exceeds 21 MW, matching our contractual demand and reinforcing our leadership in sustainable energy practices.

9. How does Mr. Shrivats Singhania Profiles collaborate with and develop relationships with key suppliers, and what benefits as a company do you see from this collaboration?

I find immense joy in being actively engaged and hands-on, which is why I dedicate a significant portion of my time to meeting individuals at our plants, collaborating with our key suppliers, and interacting with all other stakeholders. These dialogues serve a dual purpose: not only do they foster robust relationships, making our partners equal contributors to the shared growth of our enterprises, but they also prove invaluable in promptly acquiring insights into the latest developments within our industry. In turn, this allows us to swiftly evolve and adapt to changing circumstances, positioning

positioning us to thrive in a dynamic environment.

10. Looking to the future, what are your plans for the company's growth in the medium to long term?

The Indian construction sector presents substantial opportunities not just in the near term, but also in the medium and long term.

Our nation is undergoing a remarkable transformation, with rapid infrastructure development driven by favorable government policies. There is a significant emphasis on advancing both the housing and infrastructure sectors, creating a surge in demand for cement, and expected to remain good for a long time. It's worth noting that India's per capita cement consumption currently stands at 270 kg per person per year, well below the

global average of 550 kgs and China's 1500 kgs per person per year. This data underscores the immense potential for growth in the cement industry within our country.

We are committed to responsibly seizing these opportunities. To that end, we have meticulously crafted a comprehensive growth strategy that aligns with the unique dynamics of the cement industry, the competitive landscape, and prevailing market conditions. This strategy is designed to provide clarity on our objectives, establish key milestones, and map out a roadmap for achieving sustainable growth over the medium to long term. Furthermore, we recognize that adaptability to evolving market trends and technologies will be pivotal in ensuring our long-term success.

